condition and as subject to bondage by ***mala***, matter, and ***karma***, ways to liberation, the acquisition of supernatural powers, temple-building, temple ceremonies, the creation of images of the deity, initiation rituals, and the use of mantras which are manifestations of divine power in the form of sounds. The *Agamas* have been graciously revealed by God as a path to salvation that is more easily understandable than the ***Vedas***. They are superior to the ***Vedas*** since they have been spoken by God.

Further reading: Goodall 1998; Goudriaan 1992; Padoux 1990; Sanderson 1990

Tarka (suppositional reasoning): this is a pattern of reasoning applied when someone refuses to accept a conclusion. Its general form is to take the conclusion and imagine its contradictory, then show that the contradictory proposition leads to absurd or impossible consequences. So the originally disputed conclusion must be true. For example, we can infer the presence of fire on the mountain from the observation of smoke. But what if someone does not accept the principle (***vyapti***) that wherever there is smoke there is fire? If they deny that there is fire on the mountain, we say, 'If there is no fire on the mountain, then there is no smoke.' If the opponent denies this, we ask them to cite an instance of smoke without fire. This is impossible, so they have to accept, 'Where there is no fire, there is no smoke.' The opponent is assuming that there is no fire on the mountain. So their rationale must be: 'There is no smoke on the mountain, because there's no fire. Where there's no fire, there's no smoke. There's no smoke on the mountain.' But the conclusion is false because contradicted by observation. So the assumption that there is no fire on the mountain must be false and its contradictory true.